

MEHRAN AGHABOZORGI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Generative Modeling: efficient generation, sample efficiency, multimodal generation

Reinforcement Learning: world models, model-based RL, offline RL, sample-efficient continuous control

Multimodal & Robot Learning: vision-language-action (VLA) policies, RL for VLAs, efficient inference for large multimodal / transformer models

EDUCATION

Simon Fraser University

Vancouver, Canada

Ph.D. in Computer Science — APEX Lab (Advisor: Ke Li); expected Fall 2026

2021 – present

- Affiliated with the Alberta Machine Intelligence Institute (Amii).

Isfahan University of Technology

Isfahan, Iran

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering — GPA 18.29/20 (ranked 1st)

2015 – 2020

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern

Jan 2026 – Sep 2026

RBC Borealis

Vancouver, Canada

- Accelerated Vision-Language-Action (VLA) policies whose inference cost limits real-time robotic control.
- Developed attention-guided token pruning and compressed-sensing token compression to cut latency and compute while preserving task success.

Research Intern

Aug – Oct 2019

Max Planck Institute for Informatics

Saarbrücken, Germany

- Enhanced the preprocessing phase of the SPASS SAT solver with Prof. Christoph Weidenbach; demonstrated improvements on competition-grade benchmarks.

Senior Developer

2017 – 2020

Morvarid

- Shipped production systems in Python, Java, Scala, and JavaScript: an anonymous, verifiable voting system and a security-focused cloud for end-to-end encrypted file storage.
- Led engineering for Ergo Pool (mining backends and payout automation) on the Ergo blockchain.

PAPERS

Dynamic Episode ALignment: Sample-Efficient Reinforcement Learning of Vision-Language-Action Models

2027

Mehran Aghabozorgi, Kian Hosseinkhani, Haowen Yao, Luis Figueredo, Ke Li

Under review at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)

PAIR: Distance-Preserving Compression for Fast Inference and Adaptation of Vision-Language-Action Policies

2027

Mehran Aghabozorgi, Kian Hosseinkhani, Kry Yik Chau Lui, Kaito Suzuki, Ken Jiankun Zheng, Andy Zhang, Dantong Niu, Trevor Darrell, Roei Herzig, Ke Li

Under review at IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)

IMLE-LLM: Latent-Conditioned Windowed Decoding for Faster Inference

2027

Alireza Moazeni, Mehran Aghabozorgi, Tristan Engst, Ke Li

Under review at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)

WIMLE: Uncertainty-Aware World Models with IMLE for Sample-Efficient Continuous Control

2026

Mehran Aghabozorgi, Yanshu Zhang, Alireza Moazeni, Ke Li

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) [project page]

IMLE-VLA: Fast Single-Step Action Generation for Vision-Language-Action Policies	2026
Kian Hosseinkhani, Qinhe Peng, George Shramko, Mehran Aghabozorgi , Jianing Qian, Tristan Engst, Alireza Moazeni, Dinesh Jayaraman, Ke Li	
<i>IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)</i> [project page]	
P-CORE: Self-Supervised Surface Consistency for Point-Based Neural Editing	2026
Yanshu Zhang, Shichong Peng, Mehran Aghabozorgi , Alireza Moazeni, Ke Li	
<i>European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)</i> [project page]	
Adaptive IMLE for Few-shot Pretraining-free Generative Modelling	2023
Mehran Aghabozorgi , Shichong Peng, Ke Li	
<i>International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)</i> [project page]	

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, Scala, Java, JavaScript
ML & Deep Learning: PyTorch, JAX, distributed training (DDP, FSDP)
RL & Simulation: MuJoCo, DeepMind Control, MyoSuite

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Helmut & Hugo Eppich Family Graduate Scholarship, Simon Fraser University (2026).
- Ph.D. Research Scholarship, Simon Fraser University — multiple terms (2024–2025).
- Graduate Fellowship, Simon Fraser University — multiple terms (2021–2024).
- ACM-ICPC West Asia Regional — **8th** (40th, Team TRIO) and **9th** (41st, Team Valar Geekolous).
- Ranked **2nd**, nationwide ICPC competition 2017 (Team Valar Geekolous).
- Nationwide AI Challenge (UIAI) — ranked **1st** (2018) and **2nd** (2017).

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer: ICLR 2026, NeurIPS 2026, ICML 2026, ECCV 2026, ICCV 2025.